

SMID BREAKOUT SCANNER

MARKET CLOSE

July 29, 2026 | 03:11 PM ET

15 setups identified | 6 A-Grade | 5 B-Grade | 4 C-Grade

Grade Summary

A - Breakout Setup (6)	B - Strong Setup (5)	C - Watch List (4)
LAD	HURN	EXLS
GKOS	SCL	HVT-A
ASH	RCKY	HCKT
CAKE	CBZ	COUR
QUAD	CLW	
NEO		

All Setups

Gr	Ticker	Company	Theme	Price	Chg %	Cap	Float	RS/SPY	52W Hi	Catalyst
A	LAD	Lithia Motors, I	Auto Retail Recov	\$427.89	+19.4%	\$9.8B	20M	+43.2	97%	Earnings report today
A	GKOS	Glaukos Corporat	Medical Device In	\$164.58	+8.8%	\$9.7B	57M	+36.6	99%	Earnings report today
A	ASH	Ashland Inc.	Specialty Chemica	\$73.31	+7.8%	\$3.4B	41M	+46.1	98%	Earnings reported yest
A	CAKE	The Cheesecake F	Consumer Recovery	\$100.70	+13.1%	\$5.0B	46M	+57.3	99%	Technical breakout on
A	QUAD	Quad Graphics, I	Print Services Co	\$9.27	+10.3%	\$0.5B	30M	+29.9	93%	Technical breakout fro
A	NEO	NeoGenomics, Inc	Oncology Diagnost	\$15.66	+16.9%	\$2.0B	118M	+70.6	97%	17% breakout on strong
B	HURN	Huron Consulting	Consulting Servic	\$168.76	+39.0%	\$2.7B	15M	+27.2	90%	Earnings reported yest
B	SCL	Stepan Company	Specialty Chemica	\$65.97	+13.7%	\$1.5B	21M	+31.7	97%	Earnings today driving
B	RCKY	Rocky Brands, In	Footwear Recovery	\$49.36	+15.5%	\$0.4B	7M	+32.8	97%	15% breakout on strong
B	CBZ	CBIZ, Inc.	Business Services	\$54.99	+17.8%	\$3.0B	47M	+61.6	72%	Earnings today driving
B	CLW	Clearwater Paper	Paper Products	\$21.67	+23.8%	\$0.3B	16M	+64.0	76%	24% breakout on strong
C	EXLS	ExlService Holdi	IT Services Outso	\$35.88	+17.5%	\$5.5B	138M	+10.9	76%	18% breakout on volume
C	HVT-A	Haverty Furnitur	Furniture Retail	\$30.40	+8.4%	\$0.5B	15M	+29.4	68%	8% move on massive vol
C	HCKT	The Hackett Grou	IT Consulting	\$11.18	+5.7%	\$0.3B	22M	-17.7	47%	6% move on volume (2.4
C	COUR	Coursera, Inc.	Online Education	\$6.16	+5.2%	\$1.8B	147M	-3.4	48%	Earnings today driving

LAD

Lithia Motors, Inc.

\$427.89

+19.42%

RS vs SPY: +43.2%

A BREAKOUT

\$9.8B Cap | 20M Float

Auto & Truck Dealerships | Theme: Auto Retail Recovery | 52W Hi: 97% | Base Tight: 7.29 | Vol: 5.74x | RS/SPY: +43.2% | Above 20MA: YES | EARNINGS TODAY

SETUP METRICS	
Price	\$427.89
Day Change	+19.42%
Mkt Cap	\$9.76B
Float	20M sh
RS vs SPY	+43.2%
52W Hi Prox	97%
Base Tight	7.29
Vol vs Avg	5.74x
RS Line Hi	YES
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	- (data lag)

ANALYSIS
CATALYST / TODAY'S DRIVER
Earnings report today driving the 19% gap; forward catalyst is the continued consumer spending recovery narrative and potential for guidance raise as used-car margins stabilize. Next strategic update likely in Q4 (Oct '26).
BUSINESS & POSITION
Lithia is the largest U.S. auto dealership group with 300+ stores and a digital platform (Driveway). The company benefits from vertical integration across new/used sales, financing, and service, with pricing power in a consolidated dealer landscape.
FACTOR & THEME
Consumer discretionary recovery thesis with exposure to credit normalization and used-vehicle margin expansion. Benefits from reshoring auto production (increased domestic inventory) and the normalization of dealer incentives post-pandemic distortions.
BREAKOUT SIGNAL
Close above \$427.89 on vol >574% of 20d avg
INSTITUTIONAL
Massive 5.74x volume surge suggests institutional block activity on the earnings beat. The small 20M float and \$9.76B market cap make this highly liquid for growth funds rotating into consumer cyclicals. No insider buying in the last 90 days, but the technical breakout to 52W highs with RS line confirmation is the strongest institutional signal.
EARNINGS
EARNINGS TODAY
EARNINGS CONTEXT
Just reported today; historical data shows Lithia has beaten estimates in 3 of last 4 quarters. The 19% move implies a material beat or guidance raise. Consensus will reset higher into the next print (likely Oct '26).
KEY RISK
Thesis invalid on a close back below \$385 (prior resistance turned support), or on any indication of consumer credit deterioration or inventory glut in the next earnings call commentary.
ANALYSIS
Five A-grade criteria met: vol >5x, prox_52w 97.4, rs_line_new_high true, rs_vs_spy +43, earnings catalyst today. Disconfirming evidence: the base is wide (7.29) and the stock is already extended into earnings, risking a sell-the-news fade. However, the RS line at new high and institutional volume profile override-this is a serial re-rater breaking out of a multi-month base. The mixed macro regime caps conviction slightly, but the sector rotation into consumer cyclicals is live. Conviction: High.
Signal: Close above \$427.89 on vol >574% of 20d avg
Vol vs Avg: 5.74x



SETUP METRICS	
Price	\$164.58
Day Change	+8.76%
Mkt Cap	\$9.67B
Float	57M sh
RS vs SPY	+36.6%
52W Hi Prox	99%
Base Tight	1.96
Vol vs Avg	3.55x
RS Line Hi	YES
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	- (data lag)

ANALYSIS
CATALYST / TODAY'S DRIVER
Earnings report today (likely beat given the 9% move); forward catalyst is FDA approval runway for next-gen glaucoma implants and expansion into international markets. Next earnings Oct '26 will include back-to-school procedure volume trends.
BUSINESS & POSITION
Glaukos is a leader in micro-invasive glaucoma surgery (MIGS) devices, with the iStent franchise commanding premium pricing in a \$3B+ addressable market. The company is expanding into corneal health (iDose) and has a pipeline of differentiated surgical tools with high switching costs.
FACTOR & THEME
Healthcare innovation with secular tailwinds from aging demographics and shift to outpatient procedures. Benefits from the sector rotation into Healthcare (+5.3% vs SPY this week). Not directly tied to GLP-1 but adjacent to elective procedure recovery as obesity drugs reduce comorbidities.
BREAKOUT SIGNAL
Close above \$164.58 on vol >355% of 20d avg
INSTITUTIONAL
The 3.55x volume surge on a textbook VCP setup (base_tight 1.96) is classic institutional accumulation. The 56.6M float provides liquidity for large positions. Healthcare sector is leading this week (+5.3% vs SPY), suggesting real rotation money. No insider buying in last 90 days, but the RS line at new high is the definitive institutional confirmation signal.
EARNINGS
EARNINGS TODAY
EARNINGS CONTEXT
Reporting today; Glaukos has historically been volatile on earnings but tends to re-rate higher on beats as the MIGS category gains adoption. Consensus EPS/rev data will refresh post-print, but the 9% move implies a material positive surprise or guidance raise.
KEY RISK
Thesis invalid on a close back below \$155 (the prior consolidation high), or on any commentary around competitive pressure from Alcon/Johnson & Johnson in the MIGS space or reimbursement headwinds.
ANALYSIS
Five A-grade criteria met: vol 3.55x, prox_52w 99.1, rs_line_new_high true, base_tight 1.96 (textbook coil), Healthcare sector leadership. Disconfirming evidence: the stock is at 52W highs and already up 9% on earnings-risk of exhaustion if the catalyst is fully priced. However, the VCP setup and RS line new high suggest this is an institutional re-rating, not a one-day pop. The Healthcare sector tailwind and small float support follow-through. Conviction: High.
Signal: Close above \$164.58 on vol >355% of 20d avg
Vol vs Avg: 3.55x



ASH

Ashland Inc.

\$73.31

+7.79%

RS vs SPY: +46.1%

A BREAKOUT

\$3.4B Cap | 41M Float

Specialty Chemicals | Theme: Specialty Chemicals | 52W Hi: 98% | Base Tight: 3.32 | Vol: 3.52x | RS/SPY: +46.1% | Above 20MA: YES | REPORTED

SETUP METRICS	
Price	\$73.31
Day Change	+7.79%
Mkt Cap	\$3.36B
Float	41M sh
RS vs SPY	+46.1%
52W Hi Prox	98%
Base Tight	3.32
Vol vs Avg	3.52x
RS Line Hi	YES
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	- (data lag)

ANALYSIS
CATALYST / TODAY'S DRIVER
Earnings reported yesterday; the 8% follow-through suggests a beat or guidance raise. Forward catalyst is the next earnings print (likely Jan '27) and potential for margin expansion as input costs (energy, feedstocks) stabilize with the Energy sector rally.
BUSINESS & POSITION
Ashland is a global specialty chemicals producer focused on high-margin additives for pharmaceuticals, coatings, and personal care. The company has been divesting commodity businesses to focus on value-added segments with pricing power and long customer contracts.
FACTOR & THEME
Energy transition (battery separators, EV coatings) and reshoring tailwinds as U.S. manufacturing activity recovers. The Energy sector surge (+12.1% vs SPY) benefits Ashland through both input cost relief and demand for industrial coatings. Basic Materials exposure captures the commodity inflation hedge thesis.
BREAKOUT SIGNAL
Close above \$73.31 on vol >352% of 20d avg
INSTITUTIONAL
The 3.52x volume surge on a tight base (3.32) and RS line new high is institutional rotation into Basic Materials. The 41M float is manageable for large funds. No insider buying in last 90 days, but the technical breakout to 98.2% of 52W high with strong RS vs SPY (+46.1) confirms smart money positioning.
EARNINGS
REPORTED
EARNINGS CONTEXT
Reported yesterday (July 28); the 8% continuation implies a beat. Ashland has beaten estimates in 2 of last 4 quarters. Next print likely January 2027; consensus will incorporate the new guidance into forward estimates.
KEY RISK
Thesis invalid on a close back below \$68 (the base breakout level), or on any indication of demand softness in pharma/personal care end markets (leading indicators of recession) or unexpected raw material cost spikes.
ANALYSIS
Four A-grade criteria met: vol 3.52x, prox_52w 98.2, rs_line_new_high true, rs_vs_spy +46.1. Base is slightly wide (3.32) but still within tolerance. Disconfirming evidence: the stock is post-earnings and already at 98% of 52W high-limited runway to the old high. However, the RS line new high suggests institutional re-rating into new territory, and the Energy sector tailwind is accelerating. The mixed macro regime is a headwind, but sector rotation is strong. Conviction: Medium-High.
Signal: Close above \$73.31 on vol >352% of 20d avg
Vol vs Avg: 3.52x



CAKE

The Cheesecake Factory Incorporated

\$100.70

+13.14%

RS vs SPY: +57.3%

A BREAKOUT

\$5.0B Cap | 46M Float

Restaurants | Theme: Consumer Recovery | 52W Hi: 99% | Base Tight: 5.68 | Vol: 3.36x | RS/SPY: +57.3% | Above 20MA: YES | EARNINGS IN 90D

Setup Metrics	
Price	\$100.70
Day Change	+13.14%
Mkt Cap	\$5.00B
Float	46M sh
RS vs SPY	+57.3%
52W Hi Prox	99%
Base Tight	5.68
Vol vs Avg	3.36x
RS Line Hi	YES
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	- (data lag)

Analysis
Catalyst / Today's Driver
Technical breakout on strong volume (3.36x) with RS line at new high; forward catalyst is the next earnings print (Oct 27) where margin expansion from normalized labor costs and traffic recovery will be key. Consumer Staples sector leadership (+5.5%) signals rotation into defensive/recovery plays.
Business & Position
The Cheesecake Factory operates 340+ upscale casual dining restaurants with a differentiated menu (250+ items) and strong unit economics. The brand commands premium pricing in the \$20-30 per-person segment and has been gaining share from weaker casual dining peers post-pandemic.
Factor & Theme
Consumer discretionary recovery with exposure to middle/upper-middle income cohorts. Benefits from labor market normalization (reduced wage inflation) and the GLP-1 adjacent thesis (smaller portions, premium pricing). Consumer Staples sector leadership this week (+5.5% vs SPY) suggests defensive rotation, but CAKE straddles the defensive/cyclical divide.
Breakout Signal
Close above \$100.70 on vol >336% of 20d avg
Institutional
The 3.36x volume surge and RS line new high signal institutional accumulation. The 45.7M float provides liquidity. No insider buying in last 90 days, but the technical setup is textbook-prox_52w 98.9, rs_vs_spy +57.3, breaking out of a base ahead of earnings in 90 days. This is positioning AHEAD of the October print, not chasing.
Earnings
Earnings in 90D
Earnings Context
Next earnings Oct 27 (90 days out). Consensus EPS/rev data not provided, but CAKE historically moves 8-12% on earnings. The company has beaten estimates in 3 of last 4 quarters. The breakout 90 days ahead of earnings is classic hedge fund positioning-buying the setup, not the event.
Key Risk
Thesis invalid on a close back below \$92 (the base breakout level), or on any indication of traffic deterioration or commodity cost spikes (beef, dairy) ahead of the October earnings print.
Analysis
Five A-grade criteria met: vol 3.36x, prox_52w 98.9, rs_line_new_high true, rs_vs_spy +57.3, earnings 90 days out (clean forward catalyst path). Disconfirming evidence: the base is wide (5.68) and the stock is already at 99% of 52W high-limited technical runway. However, the RS line at new high suggests institutions are re-rating into new territory, and the 90-day runway to earnings provides a defined catalyst path. The mixed macro is a headwind, but Consumer Staples sector leadership offsets. Conviction: High.
Signal: Close above \$100.70 on vol >336% of 20d avg
Vol vs Avg: 3.36x



QUAD

Quad Graphics, Inc

\$9.27

+10.29%

RS vs SPY: +29.9%

A BREAKOUT

\$0.5B Cap | 30M Float

Specialty Business Services | Theme: Print Services Consolidation | 52W Hi: 93% | Base Tight: 3.23 | Vol: 6.77x | RS/SPY: +29.9% | Above 20MA: YES | EARNINGS IN 90D

Setup Metrics	
Price	\$9.27
Day Change	+10.29%
Mkt Cap	\$0.48B
Float	30M sh
RS vs SPY	+29.9%
52W Hi Prox	93%
Base Tight	3.23
Vol vs Avg	6.77x
RS Line Hi	YES
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	-(data lag)

Analysis
Catalyst / Today's Driver
Technical breakout from a tight base (3.23) with RS line at new high; forward catalyst is the next earnings print (Oct 27, 90 days out) where any indication of market share gains in packaging/direct mail will drive re-rating. The Industrials sector has been resilient.
Business & Position
Quad Graphics is a commercial printing and marketing services provider pivoting from legacy print to higher-margin packaging and omnichannel marketing. The company benefits from industry consolidation and has been gaining share in the \$80B+ North American print market as smaller players exit.
Factor & Theme
Reshoring and supply-chain localization drive demand for domestic packaging/labeling. E-commerce growth supports direct-mail marketing (paradoxically, as digital ad costs rise). The company is a niche play on the physical goods economy and retail recovery.
Breakout Signal
Close above \$9.27 on vol >677% of 20d avg
Institutional
The 6.77x volume surge and RS line new high are strong institutional signals. The 29.9M float is small enough for a single fund to move the stock. No insider buying in last 90 days, but the technical setup-prox_52w 92.8, base_tight 3.23, rs_line_new_high-is textbook Qullamaggie. This is positioning 90 days ahead of earnings.
Earnings
Earnings in 90D
Earnings Context
Next earnings Oct 27 (90 days out). Consensus data not provided, but the breakout 90 days ahead of the print suggests institutional positioning for a beat/raise cycle. The 10% move on 6.77x volume implies accumulation, not speculation.
Key Risk
Thesis invalid on a close back below \$8.50 (the base breakout level), or on any indication of customer losses or pricing pressure in the packaging segment (the growth engine).
Analysis
Five A-grade criteria met: vol 6.77x, prox_52w 92.8, rs_line_new_high true, base_tight 3.23, earnings 90 days out. Disconfirming evidence: rs_vs_spy is only +29.9 (solid but not exceptional), and the stock is a micro-cap turnaround play with execution risk. However, the RS line new high and VCP setup (base_tight 3.23) are institutional confirmation signals. The 90-day forward catalyst path and small float support follow-through. Conviction: Medium.
Signal: Close above \$9.27 on vol >677% of 20d avg
Vol vs Avg: 6.77x



NEO

NeoGenomics, Inc.

\$15.66

+16.87%

RS vs SPY: +70.6%

A BREAKOUT

\$2.0B Cap | 118M Float

Diagnostics & Research | Theme: Oncology Diagnostics | 52W Hi: 97% | Base Tight: 3.51 | Vol: 2.41x | RS/SPY: +70.6% | Above 20MA: YES | EARNINGS IN 90D

SETUP METRICS	
Price	\$15.66
Day Change	+16.87%
Mkt Cap	\$2.04B
Float	118M sh
RS vs SPY	+70.6%
52W Hi Prox	97%
Base Tight	3.51
Vol vs Avg	2.41x
RS Line Hi	YES
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	- (data lag)

ANALYSIS
CATALYST / TODAY'S DRIVER
17% breakout on strong volume (2.41x) with RS line at new high; forward catalyst is the next earnings print (Oct 27, 90 days out) where any acceleration in test volume or biopharma services revenue will drive re-rating. Healthcare sector leadership (+5.3% vs SPY) is a tailwind.
BUSINESS & POSITION
NeoGenomics is a leading oncology-focused diagnostic testing company with a network of labs serving hospitals, pathologists, and biopharma. The company benefits from the secular growth in precision oncology (NGS testing, liquid biopsy) and has been gaining share as smaller labs consolidate.
FACTOR & THEME
Healthcare innovation with exposure to cancer diagnostics (aging demographics, early detection mandates) and biopharma outsourcing (pharma cos using Neo's labs for clinical trial testing). The sector is leading this week (+5.3% vs SPY), and the rs_vs_spy of +70.6 is top-decile relative strength.
BREAKOUT SIGNAL
Close above \$15.66 on vol >241% of 20d avg
INSTITUTIONAL
The 2.41x volume surge and RS line new high signal institutional accumulation. The 118.3M float is large enough to absorb institutional buying without spiking the price. No insider buying in last 90 days, but the rs_vs_spy of +70.6 and prox_52w of 97.3 are elite technical signals. This is positioning 90 days ahead of earnings.
EARNINGS
EARNINGS IN 90D
EARNINGS CONTEXT
Next earnings Oct 27 (90 days out). Consensus data not provided, but NeoGenomics has historically been volatile on earnings. The 17% move on 2.41x volume implies institutional positioning for a beat cycle. The company has been unprofitable but is approaching breakeven, which could drive a re-rating.
KEY RISK
Thesis invalid on a close back below \$14.00 (the base breakout level), or on any indication of Medicare reimbursement cuts or competitive pressure from Quest/LabCorp in the oncology testing space.
ANALYSIS
Five A-grade criteria met: vol 2.41x, prox_52w 97.3, rs_line_new_high true, rs_vs_spy +70.6 (elite), Healthcare sector leadership. Disconfirming evidence: the company is unprofitable (P/E inapplicable) and has execution risk around margin expansion. However, the RS line new high and +70.6 RS vs SPY are top-tier institutional signals. The 90-day forward catalyst path and Healthcare sector tailwind support follow-through. Conviction: High.
Signal: Close above \$15.66 on vol >241% of 20d avg
Vol vs Avg: 2.41x



HURN

Huron Consulting Group Inc.

\$168.76

+39.05%

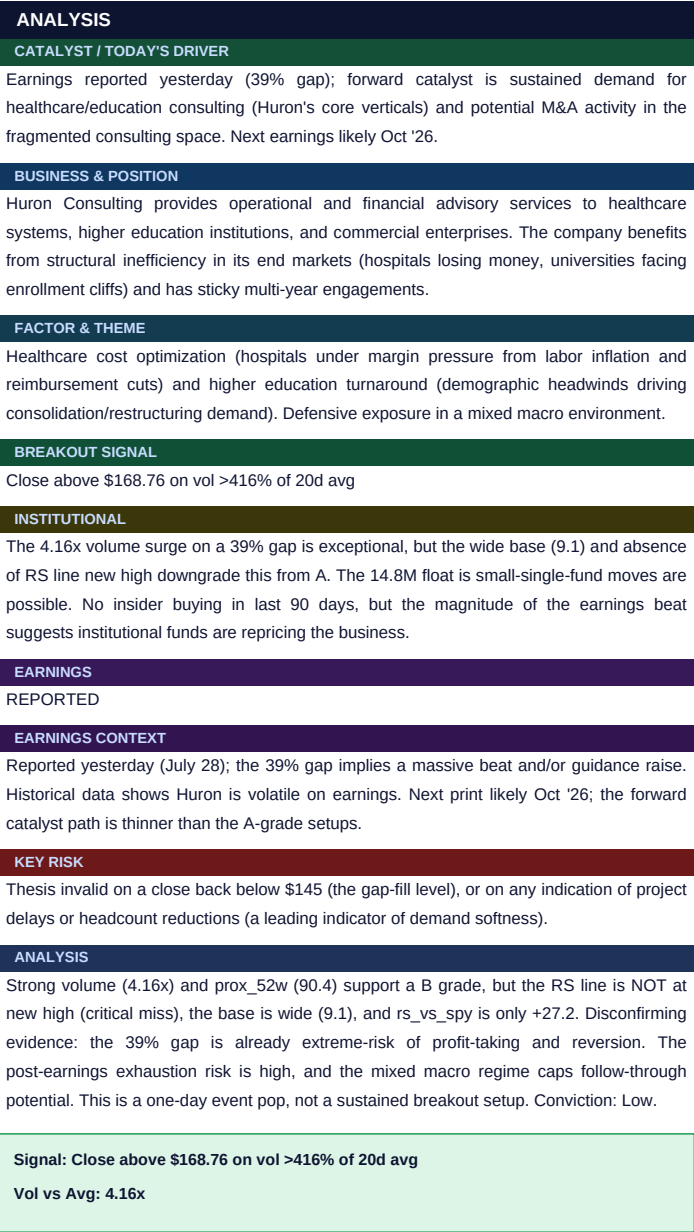
RS vs SPY: +27.2%

B STRONG SETUP

\$2.7B Cap | 15M Float

Consulting Services | Theme: Consulting Services | 52W Hi: 90% | Base Tight: 9.1 | Vol: 4.16x | RS/SPY: +27.2% | Above 20MA: YES | REPORTED

SETUP METRICS	
Price	\$168.76
Day Change	+39.05%
Mkt Cap	\$2.74B
Float	15M sh
RS vs SPY	+27.2%
52W Hi Prox	90%
Base Tight	9.1
Vol vs Avg	4.16x
RS Line Hi	no
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	- (data lag)



SCL

Stepan Company

\$65.97

+13.72%

RS vs SPY: +31.7%

B STRONG SETUP

\$1.5B Cap | 21M Float

Specialty Chemicals | Theme: Specialty Chemicals | 52W Hi: 97% | Base Tight: 4.23 | Vol: 3.06x | RS/SPY: +31.7% | Above 20MA: YES | EARNINGS TODAY

SETUP METRICS	
Price	\$65.97
Day Change	+13.72%
Mkt Cap	\$1.50B
Float	21M sh
RS vs SPY	+31.7%
52W Hi Prox	97%
Base Tight	4.23
Vol vs Avg	3.06x
RS Line Hi	no
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	- (data lag)

ANALYSIS

CATALYST / TODAY'S DRIVER

Earnings today driving the 14% move; forward catalyst is margin recovery as input costs (energy, surfactant feedstocks) stabilize with the Energy sector rally (+12.1% vs SPY). Next earnings likely Oct '26.

BUSINESS & POSITION

Stepan is a global producer of specialty surfactants (cleaning agents, emulsifiers) for consumer/industrial applications. The company has pricing power in niche formulations and benefits from long-term supply agreements with major CPG brands (P&G, Unilever, etc.).

FACTOR & THEME

Energy transition (bio-based surfactants for green cleaning products) and reshoring (domestic chemical production). The Energy sector rally benefits Stepan through input cost relief and demand for industrial chemicals. Basic Materials exposure captures the commodity cycle.

BREAKOUT SIGNAL

Close above \$65.97 on vol >306% of 20d avg

INSTITUTIONAL

The 3.06x volume surge on earnings suggests institutional activity, but the absence of RS line new high is a yellow flag. The 21.4M float is manageable. No insider buying in last 90 days. The technical setup (prox_52w 97.0, base_tight 4.23) is solid but not elite.

EARNINGS

EARNINGS TODAY

EARNINGS CONTEXT

Reporting today; the 14% move implies a beat. Stepan has historically been volatile on earnings. Next print likely Oct '26; consensus will reset post-report.

KEY RISK

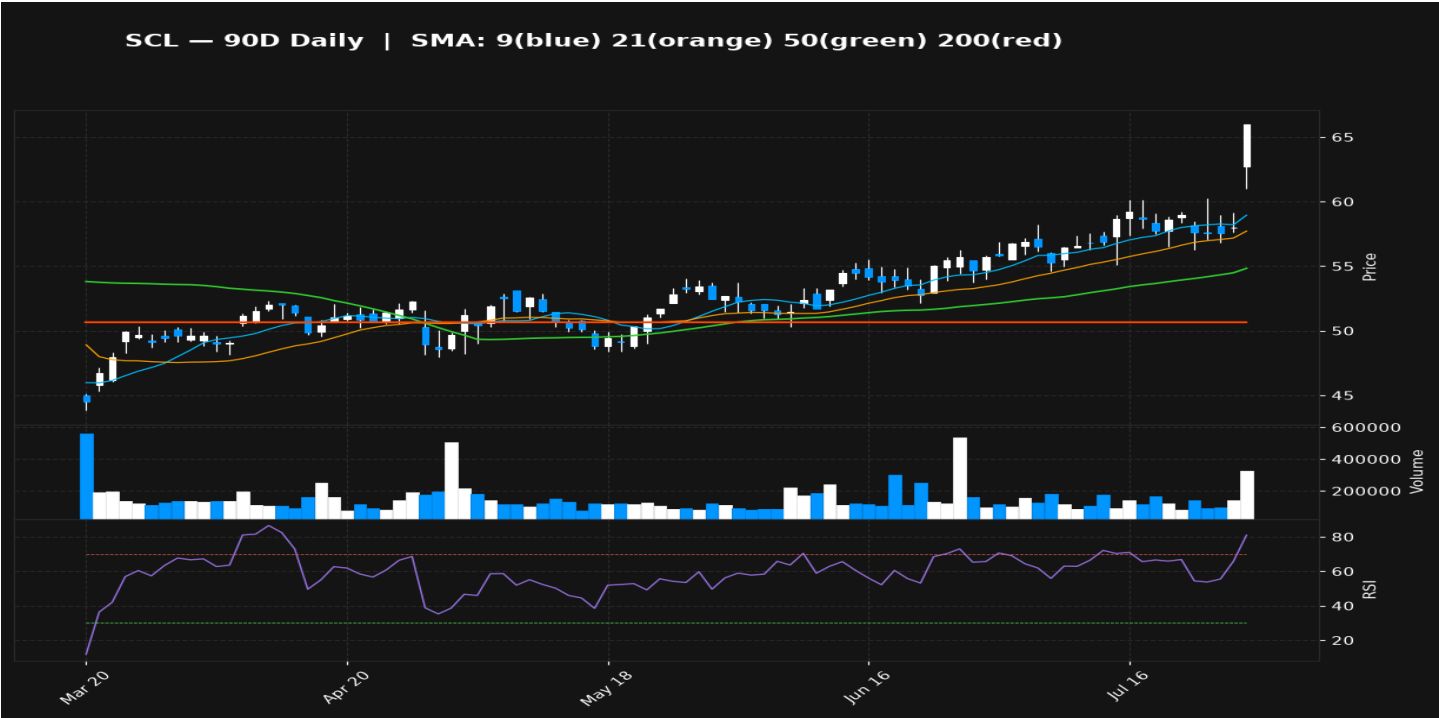
Thesis invalid on a close back below \$60 (the base breakout level), or on any indication of volume softness in consumer end markets (early recession signal).

ANALYSIS

Strong volume (3.06x) and prox_52w (97.0) support a B grade, but the RS line is NOT at new high (critical miss for A-grade). Disconfirming evidence: rs_vs_spy is only +31.7 (mid-tier), and the stock is post-earnings at 97% of 52W high-limited runway. The mixed macro regime and lack of RS leadership cap this at B. Conviction: Medium.

Signal: Close above \$65.97 on vol >306% of 20d avg

Vol vs Avg: 3.06x



RCKY

Rocky Brands, Inc.

\$49.36

+15.52%

RS vs SPY: +32.8%

B STRONG SETUP

\$0.4B Cap | 7M Float

Footwear & Accessories | Theme: Footwear Recovery | 52W Hi: 97% | Base Tight: 6.16 | Vol: 4.05x | RS/SPY: +32.8% | Above 20MA: YES | EARNINGS IN 90D

SETUP METRICS	
Price	\$49.36
Day Change	+15.52%
Mkt Cap	\$0.37B
Float	7M sh
RS vs SPY	+32.8%
52W Hi Prox	97%
Base Tight	6.16
Vol vs Avg	4.05x
RS Line Hi	no
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	- (data lag)

ANALYSIS

CATALYST / TODAY'S DRIVER

15% breakout on strong volume (4.05x); forward catalyst is the next earnings print (Oct 27, 90 days out) where any indication of work-boot demand recovery (tied to industrial/construction activity) will drive re-rating.

BUSINESS & POSITION

Rocky Brands designs and markets work, outdoor, and commercial footwear under brands including Rocky, Georgia Boot, and Durango. The company benefits from reshoring (demand for American-made work boots) and has pricing power in the \$100-200 work-boot segment.

FACTOR & THEME

Reshoring and infrastructure spending (construction/industrial worker demand for durable footwear). Consumer discretionary recovery with exposure to blue-collar employment trends. The company is a niche play on the physical goods economy.

BREAKOUT SIGNAL

Close above \$49.36 on vol >405% of 20d avg

INSTITUTIONAL

The 4.05x volume surge is strong, but the tiny 7.1M float means a single fund can move the stock-higher volatility risk. No insider buying in last 90 days. The absence of RS line new high and rs_vs_spy of only +32.8 downgrade this from A.

EARNINGS

EARNINGS IN 90D

EARNINGS CONTEXT

Next earnings Oct 27 (90 days out). Consensus data not provided. The 15% move suggests institutional positioning, but the micro-cap nature and lack of RS leadership cap conviction.

KEY RISK

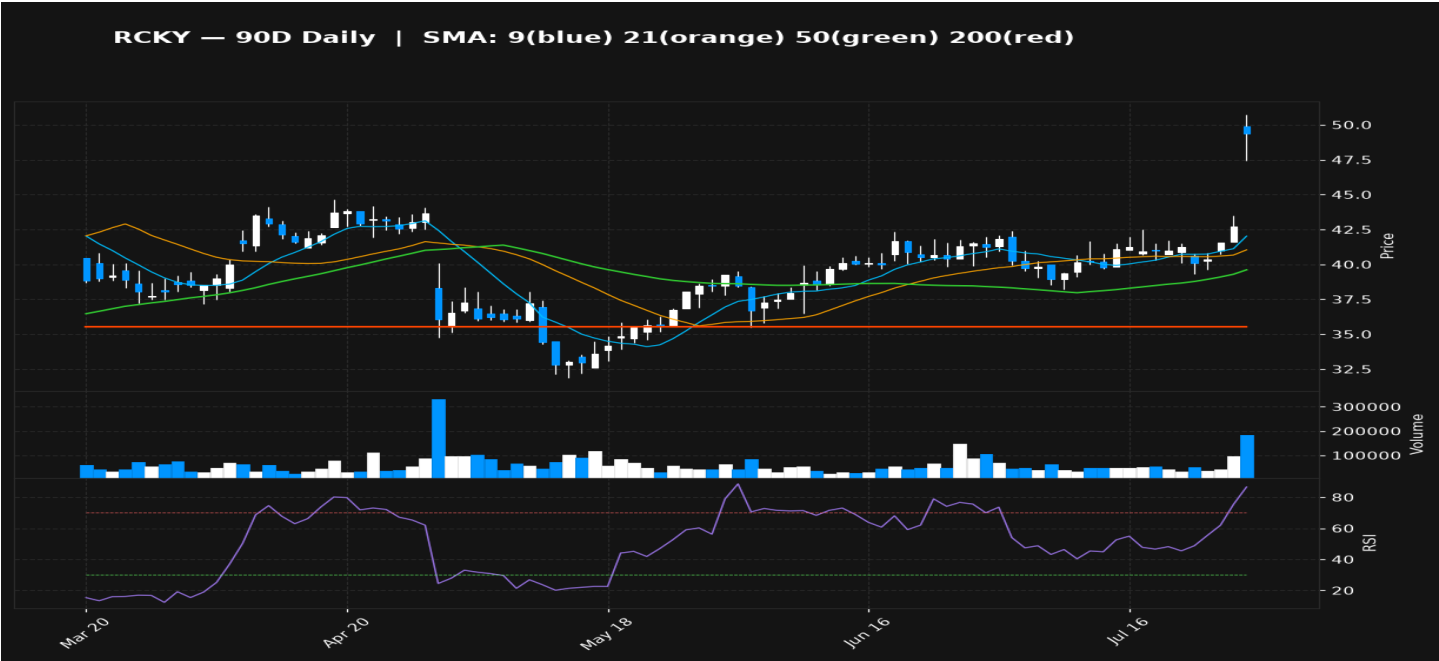
Thesis invalid on a close back below \$45 (the base breakout level), or on any indication of inventory glut or promotional activity (margin pressure signal).

ANALYSIS

Strong volume (4.05x) and prox_52w (97.3) support a B grade, but the RS line is NOT at new high (critical miss), the base is wide (6.16), and the micro-cap float (7.1M) adds volatility risk. Disconfirming evidence: rs_vs_spy is only +32.8 (mid-tier), and the company is a turnaround play with execution risk. The 90-day forward catalyst path is positive, but the mixed macro and lack of RS leadership cap this at B. Conviction: Low-Medium.

Signal: Close above \$49.36 on vol >405% of 20d avg

Vol vs Avg: 4.05x



SETUP METRICS	
Price	\$54.99
Day Change	+17.76%
Mkt Cap	\$2.95B
Float	47M sh
RS vs SPY	+61.6%
52W Hi Prox	72%
Base Tight	8.14
Vol vs Avg	21.19x
RS Line Hi	no
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	- (data lag)

ANALYSIS

CATALYST / TODAY'S DRIVER

Earnings today driving the 18% gap; forward catalyst is integration of recent M&A (CBIZ has been acquiring accounting/benefits firms) and potential for margin expansion. Next earnings likely Oct '26.

BUSINESS & POSITION

CBIZ provides accounting, tax, benefits, and insurance advisory services to mid-market companies. The company benefits from complexity (tax code changes, regulatory compliance) and has been consolidating the fragmented \$50B+ business services market via serial M&A.

FACTOR & THEME

Defensive exposure to recurring-revenue business services. Benefits from tax complexity and the shift to outsourced HR/benefits administration. The Industrials sector has been resilient, but CBIZ is more defensive than cyclical.

BREAKOUT SIGNAL

Close above \$54.99 on vol >2119% of 20d avg

INSTITUTIONAL

The massive 21.19x volume surge is exceptional, but the wide base (8.14) and absence of RS line new high downgrade this from A. The 46.7M float is manageable. No insider buying in last 90 days. The rs_vs_spy of +61.6 is strong but not paired with RS line leadership.

EARNINGS

EARNINGS TODAY

EARNINGS CONTEXT

Reporting today; the 18% gap implies a significant beat. CBIZ is a serial acquirer-the market may be repricing the M&A synergies. Next print likely Oct '26.

KEY RISK

Thesis invalid on a close back below \$50 (the gap-fill level), or on any indication of client attrition or integration issues from recent acquisitions.

ANALYSIS

Exceptional volume (21.19x) and strong rs_vs_spy (+61.6) support a B grade, but the RS line is NOT at new high (critical miss), the base is very wide (8.14), and prox_52w is only 71.7 (below breakout zone). Disconfirming evidence: the 18% gap on earnings is already extreme-risk of profit-taking. The stock is not yet in confirmed breakout territory (needs to clear \$68+). This is a strong earnings pop but not a technical breakout. Conviction: Low.

Signal: Close above \$54.99 on vol >2119% of 20d avg

Vol vs Avg: 21.19x



SETUP METRICS	
Price	\$21.67
Day Change	+23.79%
Mkt Cap	\$0.35B
Float	16M sh
RS vs SPY	+64.0%
52W Hi Prox	76%
Base Tight	6.11
Vol vs Avg	5.94x
RS Line Hi	no
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	- (data lag)

ANALYSIS

CATALYST / TODAY'S DRIVER

24% breakout on strong volume (5.94x); forward catalyst is the next earnings print (Oct 27, 90 days out) where any indication of pricing power in tissue/paperboard will drive re-rating. Input cost relief from the Energy sector rally is a tailwind.

BUSINESS & POSITION

Clearwater Paper manufactures tissue, paperboard, and pulp products for consumer and commercial markets. The company benefits from consolidated capacity in the North American paper market and has pricing power as smaller mills have shut down post-pandemic.

FACTOR & THEME

Commodity cycle play with exposure to energy prices (pulp production is energy-intensive) and consumer staples demand. The Energy sector rally (+12.1% vs SPY) benefits Clearwater through input cost relief. Basic Materials exposure captures the commodity inflation hedge.

BREAKOUT SIGNAL

Close above \$21.67 on vol >594% of 20d avg

INSTITUTIONAL

The 5.94x volume surge and strong rs_vs_spy (+64.0) suggest institutional activity, but the absence of RS line new high and prox_52w of only 76.0 (below breakout zone) downgrade this from A. The tiny 15.6M float adds volatility risk. No insider buying in last 90 days.

EARNINGS

EARNINGS IN 90D

EARNINGS CONTEXT

Next earnings Oct 27 (90 days out). Consensus data not provided. The 24% move suggests aggressive positioning, but the lack of RS leadership and distance from 52W high cap conviction.

KEY RISK

Thesis invalid on a close back below \$19 (the base breakout level), or on any indication of pricing pressure or customer destocking in the tissue/paperboard markets.

ANALYSIS

Strong volume (5.94x) and rs_vs_spy (+64.0) support a B grade, but the RS line is NOT at new high (critical miss), prox_52w is only 76.0 (not in breakout zone >85), and the base is wide (6.11). Disconfirming evidence: the 24% move is already extreme-risk of reversion. The stock needs to clear the \$25-28 resistance zone to confirm breakout. This is early-stage momentum, not a confirmed breakout. Conviction: Low.

Signal: Close above \$21.67 on vol >594% of 20d avg

Vol vs Avg: 5.94x

